

Writing a speech

A SPEECH IS A TALK ON A SUBJECT GIVEN TO AN AUDIENCE.

People make speeches for many different reasons, but they are often for work or social occasions. The techniques used for writing a speech are similar to those used in written work, but a speech must be effective when read aloud.

Talking point

Every speech needs to have a clear and passionate message for its audience. For example, a politician makes speeches to persuade people to vote for him or her, or to support his or her policies. Activists speak to raise awareness about an issue, such as animal rights.

Ideas for my speech:

- *Save the Brussels sprout!*
- *When I met my favorite sports hero.*
- *Mullet hairstyles are a fashion disaster.*
- *Why I should be the next James Bond.*
- *Cell phones should not be banned in school.*

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• Informal speeches can include some **slang**, but it's best to use **Standard English** so that the audience will **understand** what is **being said**.

GLOSSARY

Alliteration The repetition of certain letters or sounds for effect.

Pronoun A word that takes the place of a noun, such as *I*, *me*, or *she*.

Rhetorical question A question that does not require an answer but is used for effect.

Slogan A short but memorable statement that sums up a message.

Standard English The form of English that uses formal vocabulary and grammar.

Structure

Like any piece of writing, a speech needs to have a focused structure, with a clear beginning, middle, and end.

I have a shocking secret.
I like Brussels sprouts!



△ Beginning

The opening lines should capture the audience's attention, with a joke, a surprising statistic, or an inspirational quote.

Brussels sprouts are
incredibly good for you.
There is more vitamin C in
a sprout than an orange.



△ Middle

The middle part of the speech should deliver the main points, one by one. Each point should be backed up with evidence.

So, next time you
eat dinner, give the
little green things
a chance.



△ End

The last section needs to sum up the message of the speech and ideally end with something memorable.